GLASSHOUSE

NO-CONFIDENCE MOTION



Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE

In a media interaction on September 24, Congress leader Rahul Gandhi claimed that his party will win the upcoming assembly elections in Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh and Telangana. For Rajasthan, however, he said the contest would be pretty close. It's natural that most politicians predict victory for their party in the run-up to elections, but Rahul's statement on Rajasthan has raised several eyebrows within the party. Speculation is that by not expressing confidence of a victory the way he has done in the other three states, the Gandhi scion has indirectly sent a message to Rajasthan chief minister Ashok Gehlot who declined to step down last year when he was asked to contest for the post of Congress president. The first family of the Congress never forgets a snub, it seems.

PAWARS FOR POWER





Ajit Pawar's chief ministerial ambitions have never been a secret. Now, there are other aspirants for the post from the Pawar parivar. Ajit's nephew and Karjat-Jamkhed MLA Rohit Pawar's supporters put up banners hailing him as a "future chief minister". Others claim that NCP (Nationalist Congress Party) chief Sharad Pawar wants to see his daughter and Lok Sabha MP Supriya Sule take charge as the state's first woman chief minister. Family politics has taken on another dimension with the Pawars.

Family Package, Anyone?



On September 22, BRS Malkajgiri MLA **M. Hanumantha Rao** resigned, having earlier rejected the party's nomination for re-election. Writing to BRS supremo K. Chandrashekar Rao, he alleged there is no democracy in the party. The pink party had turned down his pre-condition: to give a ticket for Medak, which he represented earlier, to son M. Rohith. The father-son duo is now vying for Congress tickets. But what of the party's one family, one seat policy?

NO ROOM FOR VETERANS



Former Bengal BJP chief **Dilip Ghosh** recently found out that he has been displaced from his room at the party's state headquarters. The Midnapore MP has a habit of meeting party workers over tea and puffed rice from time to time. However, recently when he entered the room designated for him at the party office, he found that the air-conditioner had been removed. He went to switch on the television only to find out that the cable had also been disconnected. Ghosh—who is credited as the most successful president of BJP's Bengal unit—had no prior knowledge about this change. Ghosh's predecessor Rahul Sinha has also lost his room to the ongoing revamp of the old building, which is slated to become a call centre.



CHANDRADEEP KUMAR

En Route to God's Own Party

If Elizabeth Antony, wife of Congress veteran A.K. Antony, is to be believed, the couple's son **Anil K. Antony** joined the BJP because of a resolution passed in the Congress plenary held earlier this year in Raipur. The Congress resolved to take certain steps to avoid promotion of nepotism within the party. Worried about his future, Elizabeth sought divine intervention through her spiritual guru Father V.P. Joseph Valiyaveetil. The priest advised her that Antony joining the BJP would brighten his political prospects. This revelation has the Congress's Kerala unit worried because other young party members could seek such divine intervention as well.

Kaushik Deka with Dhaval Kulkarni, Amarnath K. Menon, Arkamoy Datta Majumdar and Jeemon Jacob